

# Divine Parthenogenesis: A Biological Framework for Understanding the Virgin Birth of 'Isa ibn Maryam (Jesus Christ)

Mohamed Amine Belachhab

Independent Researcher

Fes, Morocco

Contact: [m.amine.belachhab@gmail.com](mailto:m.amine.belachhab@gmail.com)

## Abstract

The virgin birth of 'Isa ibn Maryam (Jesus Christ, peace be upon him) represents a central miracle in both Islamic and Christian theology, yet interpretations of its theological implications differ fundamentally. Christianity asserts that the absence of a biological father necessitates divine paternity, concluding that Jesus is the "Son of God." Islam affirms the miraculous virgin birth while categorically rejecting any notion of divine sonship, maintaining that 'Isa (AS) was a human prophet created by Allah's command, comparable to the creation of Adam (AS). This paper proposes a scientifically-grounded biological framework for understanding the virgin birth through the lens of divine parthenogenesis—specifically, the direct creation of a diploid (2N) ovum by Allah (SWT). By examining natural parthenogenesis in various species, reviewing human reproductive biology, and analyzing the Quranic account, we demonstrate that miraculous creation without a human father does not imply divine paternity. Rather, it represents Allah's creative power operating through biological mechanisms, producing a fully human individual with no divine essence. This framework reconciles the miracle with biological plausibility while refuting the theological foundation for Christian claims of divine sonship. We conclude that 'Isa (AS) is a messenger and servant of Allah, created miraculously as a sign for humanity, but fundamentally human and created—not begotten, not divine, and emphatically not the son of God.

**Keywords:** virgin birth, parthenogenesis, 'Isa ibn Maryam, Jesus Christ, Islamic theology, reproductive biology, miraculous conception, Quranic perspective, comparative theology

## 1. Introduction

### 1.1 The Virgin Birth: A Shared Miracle, Divergent Interpretations

The virgin birth of Jesus Christ ('Isa ibn Maryam in Arabic, peace be upon him) is affirmed by both Christianity and Islam as a historical and miraculous event. The Quran explicitly confirms that Maryam (Mary, may Allah be pleased with her) conceived 'Isa without the intervention of any man:

"And [mention] the one who guarded her chastity, so We blew into her [garment] through Our angel [Gabriel], and We made her and her son a sign for the worlds." (Quran 21:91)

"She said, 'My Lord, how will I have a child when no man has touched me?' [The angel] said, 'Such is Allah; He creates what He wills. When He decrees a matter, He only says to it, "Be," and it is.'" (Quran 3:47)

Despite this shared affirmation of the virgin birth, the theological conclusions drawn from it differ fundamentally:

#### Christian Interpretation:

- The absence of a biological father is interpreted as evidence that God Himself is the father
- This leads to the doctrine of divine sonship: Jesus is the "Son of God"

- The virgin birth is used as proof of Jesus's divine nature
- This forms the foundation for the doctrine of the Trinity

**Islamic Interpretation:**

- The absence of a biological father is evidence of Allah's creative power, not paternity
- 'Isa (AS) is a created human being, a prophet and messenger, but not divine
- The virgin birth is a sign and miracle, comparable to the creation of Adam (AS)
- Allah does not beget, nor is He begotten (Quran 112:3)

**1.2 The Central Theological Question**

The crux of the disagreement is this: **Does miraculous creation without a human father necessitate divine paternity?**

Christianity answers: **Yes** → Jesus must be the Son of God.

Islam answers: **No** → 'Isa is a miraculous creation, but still a created servant of Allah.

**1.3 Objectives of This Paper**

This paper aims to:

1. **Provide a biological framework** for understanding the virgin birth through natural parthenogenetic mechanisms
2. **Demonstrate scientifically** that conception without a human father does not require divine paternity
3. **Propose a specific mechanism:** direct creation of a diploid (2N) ovum by Allah (SWT)
4. **Show the parallel** between 'Isa's creation and Adam's creation
5. **Refute the logical foundation** for the Christian doctrine of divine sonship
6. **Affirm Islamic theology:** 'Isa (AS) is fully human, a prophet, and a servant of Allah—not His son

**1.4 Methodological Approach**

We will:

- Review natural parthenogenesis in various species
- Examine human reproductive biology
- Propose a biologically coherent mechanism for the virgin birth
- Analyze relevant Quranic verses
- Present theological argumentation based on Islamic sources
- Demonstrate why miraculous creation ≠ divine nature

---

**2. Parthenogenesis in Nature: Biological Precedent for Virgin Birth**

**2.1 Definition and Overview**

**Parthenogenesis** (from Greek: *παρθένος* *parthenos* "virgin" + *γένεσις* *genesis* "creation") is a form of asexual reproduction in which an embryo develops from an unfertilized egg cell, without genetic contribution from a male gamete.

Parthenogenesis occurs naturally in numerous species across the animal kingdom, demonstrating that virgin birth is not biologically impossible—it is simply rare in complex organisms.

**2.2 Types of Parthenogenesis**

**1. Automixis (Meiotic Parthenogenesis)**

- The egg undergoes meiosis (reduction division)
- Diploidy is restored through various mechanisms (fusion of polar bodies, gamete duplication, etc.)
- Offspring are not genetically identical to the mother
- Found in some insects, reptiles

## 2. Apomixis (Mitotic Parthenogenesis)

- The egg does not undergo meiosis
- Offspring are genetic clones of the mother
- Found in some invertebrates, plants

## 3. Gynogenesis

- Sperm triggers development but contributes no genetic material
- Found in some fish and amphibians

## 2.3 Documented Cases in Vertebrates

Parthenogenesis has been documented in various vertebrate species:

### Reptiles:

- **Komodo dragons** (*Varanus komodoensis*): Multiple documented cases of virgin births in captivity
- **Various lizard species**: Some whiptail lizards (*Aspidoscelis*) are entirely parthenogenetic—no males exist
- **Snakes**: Several species including pit vipers and boas

### Birds:

- **Domestic turkeys**: Parthenogenesis occurs in 15-40% of unfertilized eggs in some strains
- **Chickens**: Rare but documented cases

### Fish:

- **Sharks**: Virgin births documented in hammerhead and blacktip sharks
- Multiple fish species exhibit parthenogenesis

### Mammals:

- Extremely rare due to genomic imprinting (see Section 2.5)
- Some artificial induction in mice (requires genetic manipulation)
- No natural mammalian parthenogenesis documented

## 2.4 The Y Chromosome Question in Parthenogenesis

A critical observation: Most parthenogenetic offspring in vertebrates are **female** because:

- The mother has only X chromosomes (XX)
- Without sperm (which can carry Y), offspring are typically XX (female)
- Male offspring (XY) from parthenogenesis are extremely rare

**Notable exception:** In Komodo dragons, ZW sex determination allows ZZ males from parthenogenesis.

**Implication for 'Isa (AS):** Since 'Isa was male, and Maryam could only contribute X chromosomes, the Y chromosome must have been created directly by Allah (SWT). This is discussed in Section 4.

## 2.5 Why Not Mammals? Genomic Imprinting

Mammalian parthenogenesis faces a unique obstacle: **genomic imprinting**.

- Certain genes are expressed only from the maternal or paternal chromosome
- Both parental contributions are necessary for normal mammalian development
- This is why mammalian parthenogenesis is virtually impossible naturally

**However:** Genomic imprinting is a biological constraint on *natural* processes, not a constraint on divine power. Allah (SWT) can create a diploid cell with properly "imprinted" chromosomes that function as if they had both maternal and paternal origins.

## 2.6 Key Takeaway

Parthenogenesis is **biologically real** and occurs across the animal kingdom. While rare in mammals due to genomic imprinting, it demonstrates that:

- Virgin birth is not scientifically impossible
- Development without male genetic contribution is a documented natural phenomenon
- Divine intervention could overcome the specific barriers that prevent mammalian parthenogenesis

---

# 3. Human Reproductive Biology: Normal and Miraculous Processes

## 3.1 Normal Human Conception

Standard sexual reproduction in humans:

1. **Gametogenesis:**
  - Female: Oogenesis produces ova (egg cells), each haploid ( $1N = 23$  chromosomes)
  - Male: Spermatogenesis produces sperm, each haploid ( $1N = 23$  chromosomes)
2. **Fertilization:**
  - Sperm penetrates ovum
  - Sperm nucleus ( $1N$ ) + ovum nucleus ( $1N$ )  $\rightarrow$  zygote ( $2N = 46$  chromosomes)
  - Zygote is diploid, containing genetic material from both parents
3. **Development:**
  - Zygote undergoes mitotic divisions
  - Develops into blastocyst, embryo, fetus
  - Born as infant after  $\sim 40$  weeks gestation

**Key point:** Normal human reproduction requires both maternal and paternal genetic contribution.

## 3.2 Chromosome Composition and Sex Determination

- **Females:** XX (two X chromosomes)
- **Males:** XY (one X, one Y chromosome)

**Sex determination:**

- Ovum always contributes X
- Sperm contributes either X ( $\rightarrow$  XX female) or Y ( $\rightarrow$  XY male)
- Therefore, biological sex is determined by paternal contribution

**Implication:** For 'Isa (AS) to be male without a human father, the Y chromosome must have been created directly.

### 3.3 What Would Be Required for Virgin Birth in Humans?

For a virgin birth to occur naturally in a human:

**Option 1: Haploid Activation (1N → Development)**

- The ovum (1N) begins developing without fertilization
- Problem: Haploid cells cannot develop into viable humans
- Genomic imprinting also prevents this

**Option 2: Diploidization (1N → 2N → Development)**

- The ovum somehow becomes diploid (duplicates its chromosomes)
- Problem: Would produce only XX (female), not XY (male)
- Genomic imprinting issues remain

**Option 3: Direct Creation of Diploid Ovum (2N → Development)**

- Allah (SWT) directly creates a diploid (2N) cell in Maryam's womb
- This cell has 46 chromosomes, including one Y chromosome
- Genomic imprinting is properly configured by divine will
- This cell begins embryonic development as if it were a normal zygote
- **This is the mechanism we propose**

### 3.4 The Proposed Mechanism: Divine Creation of a 2N Ovum

**Step 1:** Allah (SWT) creates a diploid cell (2N, 46 chromosomes) directly in Maryam's womb

**Step 2:** This cell contains:

- 46 chromosomes consistent with human genome
- One X and one Y chromosome (making it male, XY)
- Properly configured genomic imprinting (as if from both parents)
- Complete genetic code for a viable human

**Step 3:** This diploid cell is **not derived from Maryam's genetics** (not a duplication of her ovum), but is a **new creation**

**Step 4:** The cell begins mitotic division and embryonic development

**Step 5:** Normal gestation proceeds; 'Isa (AS) is born

**Analogy to Adam (AS):**

- Adam was created from clay/dust—non-living matter → living human
- 'Isa was created from a divinely-formed cell—created directly in living tissue
- Both bypassed normal reproductive processes
- Both are miracles of creation, not evidence of divinity

### 3.5 Why This Mechanism Makes Sense

**Theologically:**

- Preserves Maryam's virginity (no sexual intercourse)
- Demonstrates Allah's creative power
- Parallels Adam's creation (both created by divine command: "Be")
- Does not require "divine paternity"—just divine creation

Biologically:

- Uses existing biological machinery (embryonic development)
- Explains how a male child could be born (Y chromosome included in created cell)
- Avoids the impossibility of natural mammalian parthenogenesis
- Provides a coherent mechanism that bridges miracle and biology

Scripturally:

- Consistent with Quranic descriptions of Allah's creative power
- Aligns with the concept of *Kun fayakūn* ("Be, and it is")
- Explains why the Quran compares 'Isa to Adam

## 4. Quranic Perspective: 'Isa's Creation as a Sign, Not Divinity

### 4.1 The Annunciation to Maryam

The Quran provides detailed account of the miraculous conception:

"And mention, [O Muhammad], in the Book [the story of] Mary, when she withdrew from her family to a place toward the east. And she took, in seclusion from them, a screen. Then We sent to her Our Angel [Gabriel], and he represented himself to her as a well-proportioned man. She said, 'Indeed, I seek refuge in the Most Merciful from you, [so leave me], if you should be fearing of Allah.' He said, 'I am only the messenger of your Lord to give you [news of] a pure boy.' She said, 'How can I have a boy while no man has touched me and I have not been unchaste?' He said, 'Thus [it will be]; your Lord says, "It is easy for Me, and We will make him a sign to the people and a mercy from Us. And it is a matter [already] decreed.'"" (Quran 19:16-21)

Key points:

- Maryam explicitly states: "no man has touched me"
- Angel confirms this is not through natural means: "your Lord says, 'It is easy for Me'"
- Purpose stated: "a sign to the people and a mercy from Us"
- It is described as a "decreed matter"—an act of divine will

### 4.2 The Mechanism: Divine Breath/Spirit

"And [the example of] Mary, the daughter of 'Imran, who guarded her chastity, so We blew into her [garment] through Our angel, and she believed in the words of her Lord and His scriptures and was of the devoutly obedient." (Quran 66:12)

The phrase "We blew into her through Our angel" (نَفَخْنَا فِيهَا مِنْ رُوحِنَا) is significant:

- *Nafakhna* (نَفَخْنَا) = "We blew/breathed"
- *Rūḥinā* (رُوحِنَا) = "Our spirit/soul/breath"

**Interpretation:** This describes the **initiation of life** in Maryam's womb—not through physical union, but through divine command transmitted by the angel Jibril (Gabriel, AS).

**Scientific correlation:** This "breathing of the spirit" could correspond to the moment when Allah created the diploid cell that would become 'Isa (AS), initiating the biological process of embryonic development.

### 4.3 The Explicit Comparison to Adam (AS)

The Quran directly addresses those who would claim divinity for 'Isa by comparing him to Adam:

**"Indeed, the example of Jesus to Allah is like that of Adam. He created him from dust; then He said to him, 'Be,' and he was."** (Quran 3:59)

This verse is crucial:

- 1. **Both are created directly by Allah:** Adam from dust, 'Isa from divine command
- 2. **Both bypass normal reproduction:** Adam had no parents; 'Isa had no father
- 3. **Same creative mechanism:** "Be" (*kun*) and it is (*fayakūn*)
- 4. **Same theological status:** Both are created beings, not divine

Logical argument:

- If 'Isa is the "son of God" because he had no human father...
- Then Adam should be even more "son of God" because he had neither father nor mother
- But no one claims Adam is divine or son of God
- Therefore, miraculous creation ≠ divine sonship

### 4.4 Categorical Rejection of Divine Sonship

The Quran explicitly and repeatedly rejects the claim that Allah has a son:

**"Say, 'He is Allah, [who is] One, Allah, the Eternal Refuge. He neither begets nor is born, nor is there to Him any equivalent.'"** (Quran 112:1-4)

**"And they say, 'The Most Merciful has taken [for Himself] a son.' You have done an atrocious thing. The heavens almost rupture therefrom and the earth splits open and the mountains collapse in devastation that they attribute to the Most Merciful a son. And it is not appropriate for the Most Merciful that He should take a son. There is no one in the heavens and earth but that he comes to the Most Merciful as a servant."** (Quran 19:88-93)

**"The Messiah, son of Mary, was not but a messenger; [other] messengers have passed on before him. And his mother was a supporter of truth. They both used to eat food. Look how We make clear to them the signs; then look how deluded they are."** (Quran 5:75)

Key theological points:

- Allah does not beget (لَمْ يَلِدْ) → He does not have children
- 'Isa ate food → He had biological needs → He was created, not divine
- 'Isa was a messenger → One among many prophets
- Everyone comes to Allah as a servant → Including 'Isa

### 4.5 'Isa's Own Testimony

The Quran reports that 'Isa himself denied divinity, even as an infant:

**"[Jesus] said, 'Indeed, I am the servant of Allah. He has given me the Scripture and made me a prophet.'"** (Quran 19:30)

The first words attributed to 'Isa: **"I am the servant of Allah"** (إِنِّي عَبْدُ اللَّهِ).

Not "I am the son of God," but **"servant of Allah"**.

"And [beware the Day] when Allah will say, 'O Jesus, Son of Mary, did you say to the people, "Take me and my mother as deities besides Allah?"' He will say, 'Exalted are You! It was not for me to say that to which I have no right. If I had said it, You would have known it. You know what is within myself, and I do not know what is within Yourself. Indeed, it is You who is Knower of the unseen.'" (Quran 5:116)

On the Day of Judgment, 'Isa himself will deny ever claiming divinity or instructing worship of himself.

## 5. Theological Analysis: Why Miraculous Creation ≠ Divine Paternity

### 5.1 The Logical Fallacy of Christian Reasoning

The Christian argument can be structured as:

- Premise 1:** 'Isa was born without a human father
- Premise 2:** If someone has no human father, God must be the father
- Conclusion:** Therefore, 'Isa is the Son of God

#### Islamic refutation:

**Premise 2 is false.** The absence of a human father does not necessitate divine paternity. It necessitates only **miraculous creation**.

### 5.2 Creation vs. Procreation: A Fundamental Distinction

#### Procreation (Begetting):

- Involves the transfer of essence/substance from parent to offspring
- Offspring shares the nature of the parent
- Implies that part of the parent becomes the offspring
- Example: Human parents beget human children who share human nature

#### Creation (Making):

- Involves bringing something into existence by command
- Creator and created are fundamentally different
- No transfer of essence/substance
- Example: Allah created Adam, but Adam does not share divine nature

#### Allah creates; He does not beget:

"He is the Originator of the heavens and the earth. How could He have a son when He does not have a companion [i.e., wife] and He created all things? And He is, of all things, Knowing." (Quran 6:101)

The verse points out the absurdity: Begetting requires a partner/spouse, but Allah has no partner. Therefore, Allah does not beget —He creates.

### 5.3 The Adam-'Isa Parallel: Identical Logic

| Aspect                    | Adam (AS)             | 'Isa (AS)             |
|---------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Father                    | None                  | None                  |
| Mother                    | None                  | Maryam                |
| Created by                | Allah's command: "Be" | Allah's command: "Be" |
| Divine nature?            | No—created servant    | No—created servant    |
| Claimed as son of God? No |                       | Yes (by Christians)   |



**Question:** If 'Isa is the son of God because he has no human father, why is Adam not also the son of God, since he had neither father nor mother?

**Christian response typically:** Adam was created from dust; 'Isa was born of a woman, so it's different.

**Islamic response:** Both are miraculous creations. The method of creation (dust vs. womb) doesn't change the fundamental fact that both are created beings. Neither is divine.

## 5.4 The Nature of Miracles

**Miracle (معجزة *mu'jizah*):** An event that defies natural laws, performed by Allah's will as a sign.

'Isa's entire life was filled with miracles:

- Born without a father (miraculous conception)
- Spoke as an infant (Quran 19:30-33)
- Healed the blind and lepers (Quran 3:49)
- Raised the dead (Quran 3:49)
- Created a bird from clay and gave it life (Quran 3:49)

**Do these miracles make 'Isa divine?**

**No.** The Quran explicitly states these were performed **by Allah's permission:**

**"And [make him] a messenger to the Children of Israel, [who will say], 'Indeed I have come to you with a sign from your Lord in that I design for you from clay [that which is] like the form of a bird, then I breathe into it and it becomes a bird by permission of Allah...'"** (Quran 3:49)

**"By permission of Allah"** (بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ *bi-idhnillāh*) appears repeatedly, emphasizing that 'Isa's miracles were acts of Allah, not evidence of 'Isa's divinity.

**Analogy:** A doctor performs surgery using his skills, but we don't call the doctor divine. 'Isa performed miracles using power granted by Allah, but this doesn't make 'Isa divine.

## 5.5 The Concept of Divine Sonship in Abrahamic Theology

**In Jewish and Islamic understanding:**

- "Son of God" is sometimes used **metaphorically** to mean:
  - Righteous servant (Israel called "son" in Exodus 4:22)
  - Close relationship with God
  - Chosen prophet

**But never literally:** No prophet in Jewish or Islamic tradition claimed actual biological or ontological sonship to God.

**In Christian theology:** The claim evolved to **literal** divine sonship, eventually leading to the Trinity doctrine.

**Islamic position:** This is a fundamental theological error (*shirk*—associating partners with Allah), the gravest sin.

**"Indeed, Allah does not forgive association with Him, but He forgives what is less than that for whom He wills."** (Quran 4:48)

---

# 6. Scientific and Theological Synthesis

## 6.1 Reconciling the Miracle with Biology

The virgin birth of 'Isa is:

- 1. **Miraculous:** It defied natural biological processes
- 2. **Real:** It actually occurred as a historical event
- 3. **Explainable through divine action:** Allah created a diploid cell directly

The virgin birth does NOT mean:

- 1. 'Isa shares divine nature
- 2. Allah is biologically or ontologically his father
- 3. 'Isa is anything other than a created human being

## 6.2 The Role of Scientific Understanding

Science can:

- Explain normal reproductive processes
- Show that parthenogenesis is biologically possible in some species
- Demonstrate the barriers to mammalian parthenogenesis
- Provide a framework (diploid ovum creation) for understanding the mechanism

Science cannot:

- Prove or disprove miracles (miracles by definition transcend natural laws)
- Determine theological truth
- Answer metaphysical questions about God's nature

**However:** Science can show that virgin birth does not necessitate divine paternity. Natural parthenogenesis produces fully normal organisms that are not divine—just organisms created through an unusual mechanism.

## 6.3 The Sign for Humanity

Allah states that 'Isa and his mother were made "**a sign for the worlds**" (Quran 21:91).

What is the sign?

Not that 'Isa is divine, but that:

- 1. **Allah's creative power is absolute:** He can create life in any manner He wills
- 2. **Human understanding is limited:** We cannot fully comprehend divine actions
- 3. **Faith requires submission:** Accepting Allah's signs without demanding complete rational explanation
- 4. **Divine mercy:** The miraculous birth was a mercy and proof for believers

---

# 7. Addressing Christian Objections

## 7.1 Objection 1: "No human father means God must be the father"

Response:

This assumes only two options:

1. Human father
2. Divine father

But there is a third option: 3. **No father—only Creator**

'Isa was not "begotten" by God; he was **created** by God, just as Adam was created. Creation does not imply paternity.

## 7.2 Objection 2: "The Bible calls Jesus the 'Son of God'"

**Response:**

1. **Biblical terminology is metaphorical:** Many figures are called "son of God" in the Bible (Adam in Luke 3:38, David in Psalms 2:7, Israel in Exodus 4:22). This was understood metaphorically, not literally.
2. **Later theological development:** The literal divine sonship doctrine developed centuries after 'Isa through Church councils, not from his own teachings.
3. **Islamic position:** The Quran corrects this theological error. Muslims believe the original *Injil* (Gospel) revealed to 'Isa has been altered, and later theological additions (like divine sonship and Trinity) are human innovations, not divine revelation.

## 7.3 Objection 3: "Jesus performed miracles—proof of divinity"

**Response:**

Many prophets performed miracles:

- **Musa (Moses):** Parted the Red Sea, turned staff into serpent (Quran 7:107-108)
- **Ibrahim (Abraham):** Survived being thrown into fire (Quran 21:69)
- **Sulayman (Solomon):** Controlled the wind and jinn (Quran 21:81-82)
- **Muhammad (ﷺ):** Split the moon, night journey (Quran 54:1, 17:1)

None of these prophets are considered divine. Miracles are **signs from Allah**, not evidence of the prophet's divinity.

'Isa himself attributed his miracles to Allah: "**by permission of Allah**" (Quran 3:49).

## 7.4 Objection 4: "The virgin birth is unique, so it must mean something special"

**Response:**

It is special—it's a miracle and a sign. But:

1. **Adam's creation is even more unique:** No father, no mother. Yet Adam is not divine.
2. **Uniqueness ≠ divinity:** Many things are unique without being divine.
3. **The Quran explicitly explains the significance:** It's a sign of Allah's power, not proof of 'Isa's divinity.

---

# 8. Conclusion: 'Isa (AS) Is Not the Son of God

## 8.1 Summary of Findings

This paper has demonstrated:

1. **Biological Framework:**
  - Parthenogenesis (virgin birth) is a documented natural phenomenon
  - Human virgin birth is biologically impossible naturally due to mammalian constraints
  - **However**, Allah (SWT) could create a diploid (2N) ovum directly, bypassing natural processes
  - This diploid cell would develop normally through existing embryological mechanisms

- This explains the virgin birth without requiring "divine paternity"

## 2. Quranic Perspective:

- The Quran affirms the virgin birth as a miracle
- 'Isa's creation is explicitly compared to Adam's—both by divine command: "Be"
- The Quran categorically rejects any notion of divine sonship
- 'Isa himself is reported to have said: "I am the servant of Allah"

## 3. Theological Analysis:

- Miraculous creation does not imply divine nature
- **Creation ≠ procreation/begetting**
- Allah creates; He does not beget
- No logical or scriptural basis for claiming 'Isa is the "son of God"

## 4. Refutation of Christian Claims:

- The absence of a human father does not necessitate divine paternity
- Miracles are signs from Allah, not proof of divinity
- 'Isa's virgin birth makes him a miraculous creation, not a divine being

# 8.2 The Definitive Islamic Position

**'Isa ibn Maryam (Jesus Christ, peace be upon him) is:**

-  A human being, created by Allah
-  A prophet and messenger of Allah
-  Born miraculously of the virgin Maryam
-  Granted miracles by Allah's permission
-  A sign and mercy for humanity
-  Honored and blessed in this life and the hereafter

**'Isa ibn Maryam is NOT:**

-  The son of God
-  Divine or part of God
-  Part of a Trinity
-  Begotten by God
-  To be worshipped

# 8.3 The Clear Quranic Declaration

**"They have certainly disbelieved who say, 'Allah is the Messiah, the son of Mary' while the Messiah has said, 'O Children of Israel, worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord.' Indeed, he who associates others with Allah—Allah has forbidden him Paradise, and his refuge is the Fire. And there are not for the wrongdoers any helpers." (Quran 5:72)**

**"They have certainly disbelieved who say, 'Allah is the third of three.' And there is no god except one God. And if they do not desist from what they are saying, there will surely afflict the disbelievers among them a painful punishment." (Quran 5:73)**

**"The Messiah, son of Mary, was not but a messenger; [other] messengers have passed on before him. And his mother was a supporter of truth. They both used to eat food. Look how We make clear to them the signs; then look how deluded they are." (Quran 5:75)**

## 8.4 Final Theological Statement

The virgin birth of 'Isa ibn Maryam is a profound miracle demonstrating Allah's absolute creative power. It is a sign for believers, a mercy for humanity, and a test of faith.

**However**, this miracle does not—and cannot—make 'Isa divine, nor does it establish any paternal relationship between Allah and 'Isa. Allah is the Creator; 'Isa is the created. Allah is eternal and self-sufficient; 'Isa was born, lived, and will die (and has been raised to Allah, to return before the end of time).

To claim that 'Isa is the "son of God" is to:

- 1. Misunderstand the nature of creation vs. procreation
- 2. Commit the gravest sin in Islam—*shirk* (associating partners with Allah)
- 3. Contradict 'Isa's own testimony and teachings
- 4. Reject clear divine revelation in the Quran
- 5. Ascribe to Allah that which is not befitting His majesty

**The Islamic testimony regarding 'Isa is clear and unequivocal:**

**'Isa ibn Maryam, peace be upon him, is the servant and messenger of Allah—a noble prophet, miraculously born, honored in this world and the hereafter—but he is NOT the son of God, NOT divine, and NOT to be worshipped. He is a created human being who worshipped Allah alone and called others to do the same.**

## 8.5 The Significance for Interfaith Dialogue

This analysis provides:

- 1. **A respectful framework** for Muslims to explain their beliefs about 'Isa
- 2. **Scientific grounding** that makes the miracle comprehensible without requiring divine paternity
- 3. **Logical argumentation** showing the theological flaws in the divine sonship claim
- 4. **A bridge for discussion** between Islamic and Christian perspectives

Muslims and Christians share reverence for 'Isa and Maryam. The key difference lies in theological interpretation. By showing that the virgin birth can be understood through divine creation (parallel to Adam) rather than divine procreation, we remove the false dichotomy that has divided these faiths.

## 8.6 The Greater Miracle: Tawhid

While the virgin birth is indeed miraculous, the greatest miracle and the central message of all prophets—including 'Isa—is **Tawhid**: the Oneness of Allah.

**"And We sent not before you any messenger except that We revealed to him that, 'There is no deity except Me, so worship Me.'" (Quran 21:25)**

'Isa preached this same message:

**"Indeed, Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him. That is a straight path." (Quran 3:51)**

The virgin birth serves the purpose of Tawhid—to demonstrate Allah's unique, absolute creative power—not to introduce partners or sons to Allah.

## 8.7 A Call to Reflection

We invite sincere truth-seekers, regardless of their religious background, to reflect:

1. **Does miraculous birth necessitate divinity?** If so, what about Adam, who had no parents at all?
2. **Did 'Isa ever explicitly claim to be God?** The Quran reports he denied this (5:116), and biblical scholars note he referred to himself as "Son of Man," not "Son of God" in the divine sense.
3. **Is God beyond procreation?** If God is eternal, infinite, and perfect, how could He beget or be begotten? Procreation implies need, change, and physicality—none befitting the Divine.
4. **What was 'Isa's message?** To worship Allah alone. Would he then claim worship for himself?

**"And [beware the Day] when Allah will say, 'O Jesus, Son of Mary, did you say to the people, 'Take me and my mother as deities besides Allah?'" He will say, 'Exalted are You! It was not for me to say that to which I have no right...' (Quran 5:116)**

## 8.8 Final Declaration

**We bear witness that there is no god but Allah, alone without partners, and that 'Isa ibn Maryam is His servant and messenger.**

**We affirm the virgin birth as a magnificent sign of Allah's power.**

**We categorically reject any claim of divine sonship, Trinity, or divinity attributed to 'Isa.**

**We declare that 'Isa, peace be upon him, is a noble prophet—but he is NOT the son of God.**

**"Say, 'He is Allah, [who is] One, Allah, the Eternal Refuge. He neither begets nor is born, nor is there to Him any equivalent.'" (Quran 112:1-4)**

This is the truth from our Lord. Whoever believes it has believed in what the prophets taught; whoever rejects it has gone astray from the straight path.

**May Allah guide us all to the truth. Ameen.**

---

## 9. References

### 9.1 Quranic References

1. Surah Al-Imran (3): Verses 45-47, 49, 51, 59
2. Surah Al-Nisa (4): Verse 48, 171
3. Surah Al-Ma'idah (5): Verses 17, 72-75, 116-117
4. Surah Maryam (19): Verses 16-35, 88-93
5. Surah Al-Anbiya (21): Verses 25, 91
6. Surah At-Tahrim (66): Verse 12
7. Surah Al-Ikhlās (112): Verses 1-4
8. Surah Al-Isra (17): Verse 1
9. Surah Al-Qamar (54): Verse 1
10. Surah Al-An'am (6): Verse 101

### 9.2 Scientific Literature

1. Watts, P.C., et al. (2006). "Parthenogenesis in Komodo dragons." *Nature*, 444(7122), 1021-1022.
2. Neaves, W.B. & Baumann, P. (2011). "Unisexual reproduction among vertebrates." *Trends in Genetics*, 27(3), 81-88.
3. Kono, T., et al. (2004). "Birth of parthenogenetic mice that can develop to adulthood." *Nature*, 428(6985), 860-864.
4. Olsen, M.W. (1965). "Twelve year summary of selection for parthenogenesis in Beltsville Small White turkeys." *British Poultry Science*, 6(1), 1-6.
5. Chapman, D.D., et al. (2007). "Virgin birth in a hammerhead shark." *Biology Letters*, 3(4), 425-427.

6. Booth, W., et al. (2012). "Facultative parthenogenesis discovered in wild vertebrates." *Biology Letters*, 8(6), 983-985.
7. Surani, M.A. (2001). "Reprogramming of genome function through epigenetic inheritance." *Nature*, 414(6859), 122-128.
8. Barton, N.H., et al. (2007). *Evolution*. Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory Press.
9. Gilbert, S.F. (2010). *Developmental Biology*, 9th Edition. Sinauer Associates.
10. Sadler, T.W. (2012). *Langman's Medical Embryology*, 12th Edition. Lippincott Williams & Wilkins.

## 9.3 Islamic Scholarly Works

1. Ibn Kathir. *Tafsir Ibn Kathir* (Exegesis of the Quran). Multiple volumes covering all referenced verses.
2. Al-Tabari. *Jami' al-Bayan fi Ta'wil al-Qur'an* (Comprehensive Clarification of Quranic Interpretation).
3. Al-Qurtubi. *Al-Jami' li-Ahkam al-Qur'an* (Compendium of Legal Rulings in the Quran).
4. Al-Razi, Fakhr al-Din. *Mafatih al-Ghayb* (Keys to the Unknown) - Comprehensive Quranic commentary.
5. Ibn Taymiyyah. *Al-Jawab al-Sahih li-man Baddala Din al-Masih* (The Correct Response to Those Who Altered the Religion of Christ).
6. Deedat, Ahmed. (1985). *Christ in Islam*. Islamic Propagation Centre International.
7. Naik, Zakir. (2007). *Similarities Between Islam and Christianity*. Islamic Research Foundation.
8. Al-Ghazali, Abu Hamid. *Al-Radd al-Jamil li-Ilahiyyat 'Isa bi-Sarih al-Injil* (The Excellent Refutation of the Divinity of Jesus from the Clear Text of the Gospel).

## 9.4 Comparative Theology

1. Brown, Raymond E. (1977). *The Birth of the Messiah: A Commentary on the Infancy Narratives in the Gospels of Matthew and Luke*. Doubleday.
2. Vermes, Geza. (2001). *The Changing Faces of Jesus*. Penguin Compass.
3. Ehrman, Bart D. (2014). *How Jesus Became God: The Exaltation of a Jewish Preacher from Galilee*. HarperOne.
4. Dunn, James D.G. (1980). *Christology in the Making: A New Testament Inquiry into the Origins of the Doctrine of the Incarnation*. Westminster Press.
5. Parrinder, Geoffrey. (1995). *Jesus in the Qur'an*. Oneworld Publications.
6. Robinson, Neal. (1991). *Christ in Islam and Christianity*. State University of New York Press.
7. Khalidi, Tarif. (2001). *The Muslim Jesus: Sayings and Stories in Islamic Literature*. Harvard University Press.

# 10. Appendices

## Appendix A: Key Quranic Verses in Arabic

### On the Virgin Birth:

قَالَتْ رَبِّ أَنَّى يَكُونُ لِي وَلَدٌ وَلَمْ يَمْسَسْنِي بَشَرٌ ۖ قَالَ كَذَلِكَ اللَّهُ يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ ۚ إِذَا قَضَىٰ أَمْرًا فَإِنَّمَا يَقُولُ لَهُ كُن فَيَكُونُ

*Qālat rabbi annā yakūnu lī waladun walam yamsasnī bashar; qāla kadhāliki Allāhu yakhluqu mā yashā', idhā qaḍā amran fa-innamā yaqūlu lahu kun fayakūn*

"She said, 'My Lord, how will I have a child when no man has touched me?' [The angel] said, 'Such is Allah; He creates what He wills. When He decrees a matter, He only says to it, "Be," and it is.'" (Quran 3:47)

### On the Comparison to Adam:

إِنَّ مَثَلَ عِيسَىٰ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ كَمَثَلِ آدَمَ ۖ خَلَقَهُ مِنْ تُرَابٍ ثُمَّ قَالَ لَهُ كُن فَيَكُونُ

*Inna mathala 'Isā 'inda Allāhi kamathali Ādama, khalaqahu min turābin thumma qāla lahu kun fayakūn*

"Indeed, the example of Jesus to Allah is like that of Adam. He created him from dust; then He said to him, 'Be,' and he was." (Quran 3:59)

On the Rejection of Divine Sonship:

قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ ۝ اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ ۝ لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ ۝ وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ

Qul huwa Allāhu aḥad, Allāhu al-ṣamad, lam yalid walam yūlad, walam yakun lahu kufuwan aḥad

"Say, 'He is Allah, [who is] One, Allah, the Eternal Refuge. He neither begets nor is born, nor is there to Him any equivalent.'" (Quran 112:1-4)

'Isa's Own Testimony:

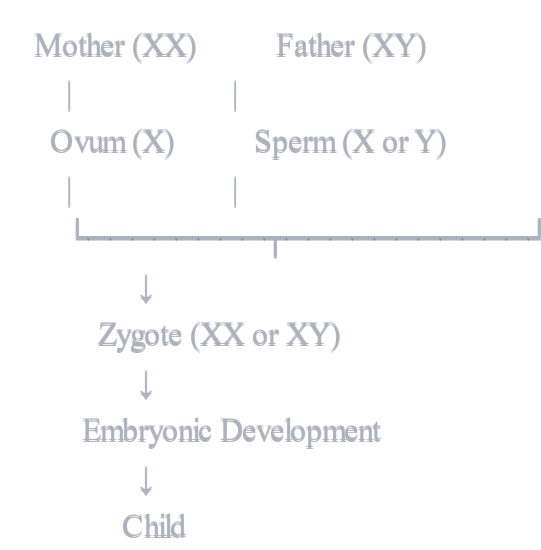
قَالَ إِنِّي عَبْدُ اللَّهِ آتَانِيَ الْكِتَابَ وَجَعَلَنِي نَبِيًّا

Qāla innī 'abdu Allāhi ātāniya al-kitāba waja'alanī nabīyā

"[Jesus] said, 'Indeed, I am the servant of Allah. He has given me the Scripture and made me a prophet.'" (Quran 19:30)

Appendix B: Biological Diagram of Proposed Mechanism

Normal Human Conception:



Proposed Mechanism for Virgin Birth of 'Isa:





Maryam (XX)



(No fertilization)

Divine Creation of Diploid Cell (XY)



[Complete 46 chromosomes created directly by Allah]

[Includes Y chromosome → male child]

[Proper genomic imprinting configured]

Cell Division Begins (Mitosis)



Embryonic Development (Normal biological processes)



'Isa (AS) - Male child

**Key difference:** The diploid (2N) cell is **created directly**, not formed through fertilization. It then develops through normal embryological processes.

## Appendix C: Timeline of Christological Development

Understanding how the doctrine of divine sonship evolved historically:

### 1st Century CE:

- 'Isa's ministry (c. 30 CE)
- Early followers see him as Messiah/Prophet
- Resurrection belief emerges

### 2nd-3rd Centuries:

- Diverse Christian communities with varying Christologies
- Some groups (Ebionites, Nazarenes) reject divine sonship
- Gradual elevation of 'Isa's status in Gentile Christianity

### 325 CE: Council of Nicaea

- Emperor Constantine convenes council
- Arian controversy: Is Jesus fully divine?
- Nicene Creed formulated: Jesus as "begotten, not made"

### 381 CE: Council of Constantinople

- Refinement of Trinity doctrine
- Holy Spirit declared fully divine

### 431 CE: Council of Ephesus

- Mary declared *Theotokos* ("God-bearer")

451 CE: Council of Chalcedon

- Jesus declared fully God and fully man (hypostatic union)

Islamic Perspective:

- These were human theological developments, not divine revelation
- The original message of 'Isa (pure monotheism) was gradually altered
- The Quran (7th century) corrects these theological errors

Appendix D: Comparative Chart - Islamic vs. Christian View

| Aspect                       | Islamic View                           | Christian View (Mainstream)       |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 'Isa's nature                | Fully human, created                   | Fully God and fully human         |
| Birth                        | Miraculous virgin birth                | Miraculous virgin birth           |
| Significance of virgin birth | Sign of Allah's power                  | Proof of divine sonship           |
| Relationship to God          | Servant and messenger                  | Son of God (literal)              |
| Divinity                     | Not divine                             | Divine (Second Person of Trinity) |
| Worship                      | Must not be worshipped                 | Worshipped as God                 |
| Miracles                     | By Allah's permission                  | Evidence of his divinity          |
| Death                        | Did not die on cross (raised to Allah) | Died on cross for humanity's sins |
| Second coming                | Will return before Day of Judgment     | Will return for Final Judgment    |
| Status                       | One of the greatest prophets           | God incarnate                     |
| Message                      | Worship Allah alone (Tawhid)           | Faith in him as savior            |

Appendix E: Glossary of Terms

Allah (SWT): The One God; SWT = *Subhanahu wa Ta'ala* (Glory be to Him, the Most High)

'Isa (AS): Jesus; AS = *'Alayhi al-Salam* (Peace be upon him)

Maryam (RA): Mary; RA = *Radiya Allahu 'Anha* (May Allah be pleased with her)

Tawhid (توحيد): The Oneness of Allah; Islamic monotheism

Shirk (شرك): Associating partners with Allah; polytheism

Kun fayakun (كن فيكون): "Be, and it is"; Allah's creative command

Parthenogenesis: Reproduction without fertilization; virgin birth

Diploid (2N): Cell with two complete sets of chromosomes (46 in humans)

Haploid (1N): Cell with one set of chromosomes (23 in humans; sperm and egg)

Genomic imprinting: Epigenetic phenomenon requiring both parental contributions

Prophet (نبي *nabī*): One who receives revelation from Allah

Messenger (رسول *rasūl*): Prophet sent with a specific message/scripture

Injil (إنجيل): The original Gospel revealed to 'Isa (AS)

---

# 11. Author's Concluding Remarks

This paper emerged from a desire to understand one of the most significant points of theological divergence between Islam and Christianity: the nature and status of 'Isa ibn Maryam (AS).

As an independent researcher exploring the intersection of science and Islamic theology, I sought to provide a framework that:

- 1. Respects the miraculous nature of 'Isa's birth
- 2. Grounds the miracle in plausible biological mechanisms
- 3. Demonstrates that miraculous birth ≠ divine nature
- 4. Refutes the logical foundation for divine sonship claims

**The virgin birth is indeed miraculous.** But miracles demonstrate Allah's power—not the divinity of those through whom miracles occur.

The parallel to Adam (AS) is, in my view, the most powerful argument. If 'Isa is divine because he had no father, then Adam—who had neither father nor mother—should be even more divine. Yet no one makes this claim about Adam. This reveals the inconsistency in the Christian argument.

**My conviction is simple:** 'Isa (AS) was a noble prophet, miraculously born, who preached the same message as all prophets—worship Allah alone. To elevate him to divinity is to contradict his own message and to commit the gravest error in theology.

I pray that this work contributes, even in some small way, to clarifying truth and inviting sincere reflection. May Allah forgive any errors in this work, which are mine alone, and may He accept any truth in it, which comes from Him alone.

**"Indeed, this Qur'an guides to that which is most suitable and gives good tidings to the believers who do righteous deeds that they will have a great reward." (Quran 17:9)**

والحمد لله رب العالمين  
*Wal-ḥamdu lillāhi rabbi al-'ālamīn*  
**And all praise is due to Allah, Lord of all the worlds.**

**Mohamed Amine Belachhab**  
Independent Researcher  
Fes, Morocco  
October 2025

# 12. Declaration of Intent

This paper is written:

- ✓ To clarify Islamic beliefs regarding 'Isa ibn Maryam (AS)
- ✓ To provide a scientific framework for understanding the virgin birth
- ✓ To refute claims of divine sonship through logical and scriptural argument
- ✓ To invite sincere seekers of truth to reflect on Tawhid
- ✓ With respect for people of all faiths, while maintaining firmness on Islamic theological principles

This paper is NOT written:

- ✗ To attack or demean Christians or Christianity as a whole
- ✗ To claim that science can prove or disprove miracles
- ✗ To impose beliefs on anyone

- ❌ With hatred or malice toward any person or group

**Muslims are commanded to engage in respectful dialogue:**

**"And do not argue with the People of the Scripture except in a way that is best, except for those who commit injustice among them, and say, 'We believe in that which has been revealed to us and revealed to you. And our God and your God is one; and we are Muslims [in submission] to Him.'" (Quran 29:46)**

May this work be a means of understanding, clarity, and—by Allah's will—guidance toward the truth.

آمین (*Ameen*)

---

**END OF PAPER**